

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for HR — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

Every Monday at 7:30am, run my HR Pulse:

1. Scan my Outlook inbox for the last 7 days for messages with HR-related topics – leave requests, resignations, manager escalations, employee relations, recruiting updates.
2. Cluster them by topic and surface the 3 most urgent (resignation risk, formal complaint, exec ask).
3. Check my Teams chats for any HR business partners I owe a reply to.
4. Draft a single Teams message I can post to the HR leadership channel summarising: top urgent items, this week's open requisitions count (read from our Requisitions SharePoint list), and one risk to flag.
5. Do NOT post automatically – leave the draft for me to review.

3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

Frequency	Weekly
Run Time	Monday 07:30 GMT (lands before standup)
Execution Mode	Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- It read your last 7 days of mail and clustered correctly (not just 1-2 threads)
- It pulled the SharePoint requisition count and shows the source
- The Teams draft is in your Drafts — never auto-posted
- Urgent items link to the original email/chat so you can verify

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

1:1 Prep Brief

For each of my direct-report 1:1s tomorrow: read their last 14 days of email and Teams with me, list 3 themes, surface anything they raised that I have not replied to. Save one Word doc per person to OneDrive in /HR Briefs/.

Quiet PTO Audit

Look at my direct reports' calendars for the last 90 days. Anyone with under 3 days of leave taken – draft a short, warm Teams message reminding them I support taking time off. Leave drafts for me to send.

Resignation Risk Scan

Search the HR business partner shared mailbox for the last 30 days for tone shifts – withdrawal language, 'I've been thinking', exit phrases. List the threads with quotes and the people involved.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Monday morning email triage
- Manual 1:1 prep across 6+ tools
- Forgetting which DR is owed a reply

With:

- ✓ A pre-staffed Monday digest ready by 8am
- ✓ Per-DR briefing docs waiting in OneDrive
- ✓ Drafts you review, never auto-sent surprises

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Start every scheduled task with 'Do NOT send/post automatically — leave the draft for me to review.' Cowork has full M365 write access; you want the muscle memory of always leaving the final click to a human. Once trust is earned, relax that on low-risk tasks.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Triage your HR inbox before you arrive
- Surface resignation and ER risk early
- Prep every 1:1 the night before
- Free your Monday for actual people work